E Major

Scale Practice Worksheet · 4 sharps (F♯, C♯, G♯, D♯) · 4 octaves

SCALES

01 **Scale**

Play E major across 4 octaves. Start with one octave if needed, then expand. Choose a comfortable tempo.

02 **Scale in Tenths**

Play E major in tenths (octave + third between hands). Add dynamics: crescendo ascending, decrescendo descending.

Practice left hand separately — avoid any spikes or unintended accents on individual notes.

03 **Scale in Sixths**

Play E major in sixths. Start with G♯ in the left hand. Apply accent patterns from the Variations section.

04 Chromatic Scale in Double Thirds

Chromatic scales are more or less the same from all keys. Start from C using major thirds. The most important thing is knowing where your fingers go — specifically where the 5th finger lands.

5th finger anchor points:

RH — 5th finger on **F** and **A♯** (top notes of those pairs)

LH — 5th finger on **F♯** and **B** (bottom notes of those pairs)

Complete fingering, ascending from C (bottom note / top note):

RH:

C–E: 1/4 C#–F: 2/5 D–F#: 1/3 D#–G: 2/4

E–G#: 1/3 F–A: 1/4 F#–A#: 2/5 G–B: 1/3

G#–C: 2/4

LH:

C–E: 4/1 C#–F: 3/1 D–F#: 4/2 D#–G: 3/1

E–G#: 4/2 F–A: 3/1 F#–A#: 5/2 G–B: 4/1

G#–C: 3/1 A–C#: 4/2 A#–D: 3/1 B–D#: 5/2

Both hands use almost the same pattern — a mirror effect. Practice separate hands first. Connect each pair of thirds as legato as possible. Then combine both hands very slowly.

> **TIP**
> Say the 5th-finger note names out loud as you practice: "F, A#, A#, F" (RH ascending then descending). This helps lock in the anchor points.

> **NOTE**
> You can also play chromatic double thirds using minor thirds. Major thirds are used here because we are playing E major.

DOUBLE OCTAVES

05 Double Octaves

Play E major in double octaves. Apply triplet groupings from the Variations section. Start slowly, then increase the tempo.

TECHNIQUE
Don't play with locked hands — this creates tension immediately. Keep the wrists free. Jump from each key and play staccato. To learn how to bounce, the wrist must be relaxed.

06 Double Octave Arpeggios

Play arpeggios in double octaves. Add contrary motion.

Practice method: Stop on every single note to check accuracy. Then connect pairs of notes. The distances vary greatly between jumps — this is what makes it a great exercise for practicing jumps.

TIP
Practice the outer voices (top and bottom notes only) before playing full double octaves.

CHORDS

07 Chords

Play solid chords with inversions. Start with a three note smaller chord to locate the position, then expand to the full four note voicing with the octave.

Practice method (from Vienna): Divide the chord into pairs of two notes and practice pressing them together simultaneously. The 3rd finger in the left hand often arrives sooner than the 5th finger, creating unevenness — the chord sounds like the fingers are not together. Practicing in pairs eliminates this.

Variation: Use three-note groups instead of pairs.

Middle voices exercise: Play the outer voices (octave frame) staccato, then add the middle voices. For variety, try an E major 7th chord. If the stretch is too big, remove one voice.

VARIATIONS

Contrary Motion

Any scale or arpeggio exercise can be played in contrary motion — one hand ascending while the other descends simultaneously. This is harder than parallel motion and excellent brain training.

Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Apply to any scale or arpeggio exercise for fluidity and evenness:

a Accent every second note — grouped, rolling feel.

b Triplet groupings — organize in groups of three.

c Dynamics — crescendo ascending, decrescendo descending.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Choose a comfortable tempo — you can always slow down or start with one octave. This is about your practice session.
- Learning positions builds muscle memory, which helps you play with greater accuracy over time